

# Connecticut State Department of Education

## DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023-24



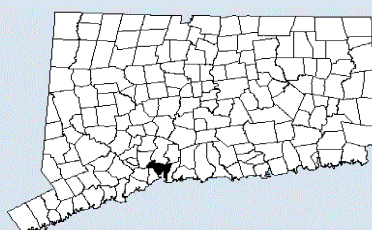
### Elm City Montessori School District

475-220-4100 • <http://elmcitymontessori.org/>

#### District Information

|                                     |             |
|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| Grade Range                         | PK-8        |
| Number of Schools/Programs          | 1           |
| Enrollment                          | 305         |
| Per Pupil Expenditures <sup>1</sup> | \$17,658    |
| Total Expenditures <sup>1</sup>     | \$5,262,172 |

<sup>1</sup> Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



#### Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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#### Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

\* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

#### Students

##### October 1, 2023 Enrollment<sup>2</sup>

|                                           | District |                      | State                |
|-------------------------------------------|----------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                           | Count    | Percent of Total (%) | Percent of Total (%) |
| Female                                    | 162      | 53.1                 | 48.3                 |
| Male                                      | 143      | 46.9                 | 51.5                 |
| Non-Binary                                | 0        | 0.0                  | 0.1                  |
| American Indian or Alaska Native          | 0        | 0.0                  | 0.2                  |
| Asian                                     | 10       | 3.3                  | 5.2                  |
| Black or African American                 | 78       | 25.6                 | 12.5                 |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race            | 84       | 27.5                 | 31.1                 |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander | 0        | 0.0                  | 0.1                  |
| Two or More Races                         | 28       | 9.2                  | 4.7                  |
| White                                     | 105      | 34.4                 | 46.2                 |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners    | 8        | 2.6                  | 10.5                 |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals  | 117      | 38.4                 | 44.0                 |
| Students with Disabilities <sup>3</sup>   | 39       | 12.8                 | 17.9                 |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

<sup>3</sup> Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

##### Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

|                                          | Chronic Absenteeism <sup>4</sup> |          | Suspension/Expulsion <sup>5</sup> |          |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------|----------|
|                                          | Count                            | Rate (%) | Count                             | Rate (%) |
| Female                                   | 15                               | 12.4     | 0                                 | 0.0      |
| Male                                     | 18                               | 17.3     | *                                 | *        |
| Non-Binary                               | N/A                              | N/A      | N/A                               | N/A      |
| Black or African American                | 6                                | 10.9     | *                                 | *        |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | 18                               | 27.7     | *                                 | *        |
| White                                    | *                                | *        | 0                                 | 0.0      |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners   | *                                | *        | 0                                 | *        |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | 22                               | 25.6     | *                                 | *        |
| Students with Disabilities               | 11                               | 26.2     | *                                 | *        |
| District                                 | 33                               | 14.7     | *                                 | *        |
| State                                    |                                  | 17.7     |                                   | 7.0      |

**Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 0**

**Number of school-based arrests: 0**

<sup>4</sup> A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

<sup>5</sup> This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

## Elm City Montessori School District

### Educators

#### Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)<sup>1</sup> Staff

|                                                           | FTE  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>General Education</b>                                  |      |
| Teachers and Instructors                                  | 16.0 |
| Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants                 | 18.0 |
| <b>Special Education</b>                                  |      |
| Teachers and Instructors                                  | 2.0  |
| Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants                 | 0.0  |
| <b>Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs</b> |      |
| District Central Office                                   | 0.0  |
| School Level                                              | 1.0  |
| <b>Library/Media</b>                                      |      |
| Specialists (Certified)                                   | 0.0  |
| Support Staff                                             | 0.0  |
| Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers            | 2.0  |
| Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists       | 1.0  |
| School Nurses                                             | 1.0  |
| Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support  | 9.5  |

<sup>1</sup> In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

#### Educators by Race/Ethnicity

|                                           | Count | District<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) | State<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) |
|-------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| American Indian or Alaska Native          | 0     | 0.0                                 | 0.1                              |
| Asian                                     | 3     | 13.0                                | 1.4                              |
| Black or African American                 | 0     | 0.0                                 | 4.8                              |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race            | 3     | 13.0                                | 5.1                              |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander | 0     | 0.0                                 | 0.1                              |
| Two or More Races                         | 2     | 8.7                                 | 0.3                              |
| White                                     | 15    | 65.2                                | 88.3                             |

#### Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

|                                                                   | District | State |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|
| Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time | 9.8      | 13.3  |

### Instruction and Resources

#### Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers<sup>2</sup>

|                            | Count | Rate (%) |
|----------------------------|-------|----------|
| Autism                     | N/A   | N/A      |
| Emotional Disability       | N/A   | N/A      |
| Intellectual Disability    | N/A   | N/A      |
| Learning Disability        | N/A   | N/A      |
| Other Health Impairment    | N/A   | N/A      |
| Other Disabilities         | N/A   | N/A      |
| Speech/Language Impairment | N/A   | N/A      |
| District                   | N/A   | N/A      |
| State                      |       | 66.8     |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

## Elm City Montessori School District

### Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability<sup>1</sup>

|                            | District |          | State    |
|----------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
|                            | Count    | Rate (%) | Rate (%) |
| Autism                     | N/A      | N/A      | 2.6      |
| Emotional Disability       | N/A      | N/A      | 1.1      |
| Intellectual Disability    | N/A      | N/A      | 0.6      |
| Learning Disability        | N/A      | N/A      | 6.4      |
| Other Health Impairment    | N/A      | N/A      | 3.5      |
| Other Disabilities         | N/A      | N/A      | 1.2      |
| Speech/Language Impairment | N/A      | N/A      | 2.0      |
| All Disabilities           | N/A      | N/A      | 17.3     |

<sup>1</sup> This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

### Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District<sup>2</sup>

|                                   | District |          | State    |
|-----------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
|                                   | Count    | Rate (%) | Rate (%) |
| Public Schools in Other Districts | N/A      | N/A      | 8.0      |
| Private Schools or Other Settings | N/A      | N/A      | 4.6      |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

### Overall Expenditures<sup>3</sup>: 2022-23

|                                                | Total (\$)  | Per Pupil     |            |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------|------------|
|                                                |             | District (\$) | State (\$) |
| Instruction                                    | \$3,166,267 | \$10,625      | \$12,942   |
| Support services - students                    | \$399,797   | \$1,342       | \$1,724    |
| Support services - instruction                 | \$159,655   | \$536         | \$905      |
| Support services - general administration      | \$137,559   | \$462         | \$520      |
| Support services - school based administration | \$558,516   | \$1,874       | \$1,207    |
| Central and other support services             | \$113,149   | \$380         | \$771      |
| Operation and maintenance of plant             | \$578,376   | \$1,941       | \$2,101    |
| Student transportation services                | \$148,853   | \$686         | \$1,582    |
| Food services                                  | .           | .             | \$8        |
| Enterprise operations                          | .           | .             | \$213      |
| Total                                          | \$5,262,172 | \$17,658      | \$21,143   |

<sup>3</sup> Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

### Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

|                                                          | District   |                      | State                |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                                          | Total (\$) | Percent of Total (%) | Percent of Total (%) |
| Teacher Salaries                                         | \$92,856   | 44.6                 | 27.6                 |
| Instructional Aide Salaries                              | .          | .                    | 10.2                 |
| Other Salaries                                           | .          | .                    | 10.5                 |
| Employee Benefits                                        | \$44,053   | 21.1                 | 13.2                 |
| Purchased Services Other Than Transportation             | \$71,498   | 34.3                 | 6.4                  |
| Special Education Tuition                                | .          | .                    | 22.2                 |
| Supplies                                                 | .          | .                    | 0.7                  |
| Property Services                                        | .          | .                    | 0.4                  |
| Purchased Services For Transportation                    | .          | .                    | 8.4                  |
| Equipment                                                | .          | .                    | 0.3                  |
| All Other Expenditures                                   | .          | .                    | 0.1                  |
| Total                                                    | \$208,407  | 100.0                | 100.0                |
| Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education |            | 4.0                  | 25.0                 |

### Expenditures by Revenue Source<sup>4</sup>: 2022-23

|                 | Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Local           | 71.0                                               |
| State           | 16.2                                               |
| Federal         | 12.8                                               |
| Tuition & Other | .                                                  |

<sup>4</sup> Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

## Elm City Montessori School District

### Performance and Accountability

#### District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

|                                                | English Language Arts (ELA) |      | Math  |      | Science |      |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|------|-------|------|---------|------|
|                                                | Count                       | DPI  | Count | DPI  | Count   | DPI  |
| American Indian or Alaska Native               | 0                           | N/A  | 0     | N/A  | 0       | N/A  |
| Asian                                          | *                           | *    | *     | *    | *       | *    |
| Black or African American                      | 31                          | 55.4 | 31    | 43.4 | 7       | *    |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race                 | 37                          | 58.0 | 37    | 47.3 | 15      | *    |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander      | 0                           | N/A  | 0     | N/A  | 0       | N/A  |
| Two or More Races                              | *                           | *    | *     | *    | *       | *    |
| White                                          | 41                          | 76.9 | 41    | 62.4 | 15      | *    |
| English Learners/Multilingual Learners         | 6                           | *    | 6     | *    | *       | *    |
| Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners | 119                         | 66.1 | 119   | 53.7 | *       | *    |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals       | 47                          | 52.9 | 47    | 42.5 | 15      | *    |
| Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals   | 78                          | 72.2 | 78    | 58.7 | 26      | 75.2 |
| Students with Disabilities                     | 23                          | 45.2 | 23    | 37.1 | *       | *    |
| Students without Disabilities                  | 102                         | 69.4 | 102   | 56.1 | *       | *    |
| High Needs                                     | 62                          | 53.5 | 62    | 43.8 | 20      | 56.4 |
| Non-High Needs                                 | 63                          | 76.2 | 63    | 61.3 | 21      | 78.9 |
| District                                       | 125                         | 64.9 | 125   | 52.6 | 41      | 67.9 |

#### National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient<sup>1</sup>

|                 | NAEP 2022 |         | NAEP 2013 |
|-----------------|-----------|---------|-----------|
|                 | Grade 4   | Grade 8 | Grade 12  |
| <b>READING</b>  |           |         |           |
| Connecticut     | 35        | 35      | 50        |
| National Public | 32        | 29      | 36        |
| <b>MATH</b>     |           |         |           |
| Connecticut     | 37        | 30      | 32        |
| National Public | 35        | 26      | 25        |

<sup>1</sup> NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at [https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card\\_NAEP-2022.pdf](https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf)

#### Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard<sup>2</sup>

|                      | Percent of Students by Grade <sup>3</sup> (%) |       |      |      | All Tested Grades |          |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------|------|------|-------------------|----------|
|                      | 4                                             | 6     | 8    | HS   | Count             | Rate (%) |
| Sit & Reach          | *                                             | 100.0 | *    | N/A  | 56                | 100.0    |
| Curl Up              | *                                             | 95.2  | *    | N/A  | 56                | 94.6     |
| Push Up              | *                                             | 85.7  | *    | N/A  | 56                | 87.5     |
| Mile Run/PACER       | *                                             | 71.4  | *    | N/A  | 55                | 74.5     |
| All Tests - District | *                                             | 66.7  | *    | N/A  | 55                | 69.1     |
| All Tests - State    | 53.6                                          | 48.4  | 44.6 | 42.3 |                   | 47.2     |

<sup>2</sup>The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

<sup>3</sup>Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

## Elm City Montessori School District

### Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

| Indicator                                                 |                     | Index/Rate    | Target | Points Earned | Max Points | % Points Earned | State Average Index/Rate |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------|--------|---------------|------------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| ELA Performance Index                                     | All Students        | 64.9          | 75     | 43.3          | 50         | 86.5            | 63.9                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 53.5          | 75     | 35.6          | 50         | 71.3            | 54.1                     |
| Math Performance Index                                    | All Students        | 52.6          | 75     | 35.1          | 50         | 70.2            | 60.2                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 43.8          | 75     | 29.2          | 50         | 58.4            | 49.5                     |
| Science Performance Index                                 | All Students        | 67.9          | 75     | 45.3          | 50         | 90.6            | 61.8                     |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 56.4          | 75     | 37.6          | 50         | 75.2            | 51.4                     |
| ELA Academic Growth                                       | All Students        | 65.3%         | 100%   | 65.3          | 100        | 65.3            | 58.7%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 57.9%         | 100%   | 57.9          | 100        | 57.9            | 54.2%                    |
| Math Academic Growth                                      | All Students        | 51.2%         | 100%   | 51.2          | 100        | 51.2            | 61.4%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 54.5%         | 100%   | 54.5          | 100        | 54.5            | 55.1%                    |
| Progress Toward English Proficiency                       | Literacy            | .             | 100%   | .             | .          | .               | 58.9%                    |
|                                                           | Oral                | .             | 100%   | .             | .          | .               | 55.2%                    |
| Chronic Absenteeism                                       | All Students        | 14.7%         | <=5%   | 30.7          | 50         | 61.3            | 17.7%                    |
|                                                           | High Needs Students | 24.5%         | <=5%   | 10.9          | 50         | 21.8            | 25.5%                    |
| Preparation for CCR                                       | % Taking Courses    | .             | 75%    | .             | .          | .               | 91.5%                    |
|                                                           | % Meeting Benchmark | .             | 75%    | .             | .          | .               | 44.3%                    |
| On-track to High School Graduation                        |                     | .             | 94%    | .             | .          | .               | 84.5%                    |
| 4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)              |                     | .             | 94%    | .             | .          | .               | 88.4%                    |
| 6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)     |                     | .             | 94%    | .             | .          | .               | 86.6%                    |
| Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)                    |                     | .             | 75%    | .             | .          | .               | 68.4%                    |
| Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate) |                     | 98.2%   69.1% | 75%    | 46.1          | 50         | 92.1            | 93.6%   47.2%            |
| Arts Access                                               |                     | .             | 60%    | .             | .          | .               | 55.0%                    |
| <b>Accountability Index</b>                               |                     |               |        | <b>542.5</b>  | <b>850</b> | <b>63.8</b>     |                          |

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

| Gap Indicators                | Non-High Needs Rate <sup>1</sup> | High Needs Rate | Size of Gap | State Gap Mean +1 Stdev <sup>2</sup> | Is Gap an Outlier? <sup>2</sup> |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------|-------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Achievement Gap Size Outlier? |                                  |                 |             |                                      | Y                               |
| ELA Performance Index Gap     | 75.0                             | 53.5            | 21.5        | 16.9                                 |                                 |
| Math Performance Index Gap    | 61.3                             | 43.8            | 17.5        | 18.2                                 |                                 |
| Science Performance Index Gap | 75.0                             | 56.4            | 18.6        | 17.9                                 |                                 |
| Graduation Rate Gap           | .                                | .               | .           | .                                    |                                 |

<sup>1</sup>If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

<sup>2</sup>If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

| Subject/Student Group |                     | Participation Rate (%) <sup>3</sup> |
|-----------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ELA                   | All Students        | 99.2                                |
|                       | High Needs Students | 98.4                                |
| Math                  | All Students        | 99.2                                |
|                       | High Needs Students | 98.4                                |
| Science               | All Students        | 100.0                               |
|                       | High Needs Students | 100.0                               |

<sup>3</sup>Minimum participation standard is 95%.

### Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

**District: \***      **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

## Elm City Montessori School District

### Narratives

#### School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Elm City College Preparatory School is a member of the Achievement First (AF) network of schools, and as such benefits from the latest available research, training, and support in providing differentiated instruction to students with special needs or requiring additional support. Team Special Services works closely with our schools' special services leaders to design programming and interventions to meet the needs of the current school population. A foundation of that support is a "special services playbook", a manual that serves as a resource to school leaders, special services leaders, and teachers in identifying and addressing needs of all students. In addition to that playbook AF provides all staff with professional development focused on mindset, co-teaching, and differentiation.

Elm City is building an inclusive environment to ensure all our scholars can achieve academically and behaviorally at high levels. Co-teaching is one vehicle for reaching inclusiveness. Additionally, co-teaching allows teachers to collect more data, provide more feedback, and offer more targeted support to lead students to the same rigorous academic and behavioral outcomes.

Elm City works with the New Haven district for the IEP process and has implemented the use of the CT SEDS system. The Elm City team meets with the New Haven district team each month to collaborate for upcoming IEP meetings. Elm City also ensures that parents and families have a space to share at the start of each meeting and to be active participants in their child's IEP meeting.

Maintaining high daily attendance rates and low chronic absenteeism rates are high priorities at Elm City. This work has intensified and become even more critical after the Covid Pandemic, as students were still missing many school days due to COVID illnesses as well as other reasons related to the pandemic. Every day, school staff reach out to parents and guardians to determine the reason for a student's absence. This step is critical in unearthing the reasons why students are absent. The attendance committee meets regularly to review attendance data to determine additional supports that are needed for students, as well as find ways to celebrate and incentivize strong attendance habits. Elm City continues to focus on ensuring student safety and maintaining family engagement as core components of student attendance.

Families receive frequent communication from teachers and school staff to engage in learning activities. Report card nights continue to be well attended. Many families are involved in the planning and leadership of school events through family leadership councils. Teachers are highly accessible to families, with their cell phone numbers being available to families to reach them after school hours. Community outreach and student recruitment is led by a dedicated Community Outreach Associate who coordinates efforts and explores partnerships with the community our school serves.

#### Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Elm City's mission is to deliver on the promise of equal educational opportunity for all of our school's children. We believe that all children, regardless of race or economic status, can succeed if they have access to a great education. Elm City schools provide all of our scholars with the academic and character skills they need to graduate from top colleges, succeed in a competitive world, and serve as the next generation of leaders in our communities. We believe the fulfillment of this mission and the reduction of the achievement gaps based on race and economic status will reduce the isolation for our scholars.

We aim to have our schools reflect the demographic composition of the neighborhoods we serve, and prepare our scholars to achieve academic success, college acceptance, and college graduation at the same rates as their more affluent peers. The schools partner with the Achievement First's recruitment team to carry out a comprehensive recruitment strategy consisting of direct outreach, Refer A Friend campaigns, information sessions, school-based open houses, presentations at local education agencies and community based organizations, neighborhood canvassing at nearby high-density housing and building locations, and geo-targeted mailings to reach families across the region. Our staff recruitment utilizes head hunting, partnerships with local universities and National, such as NFBLME and Profound Gentlemen, to ensure we are intentionally diversifying our candidate pool. In addition, we advertise our career openings across diverse areas and websites to establish our brand awareness and openings with candidates of all demographics and backgrounds.

Preparation for the college experience begins in the 9th grade with the Foundations of Leadership course. This four-year program is designed to help scholars learn how to navigate the more complex high school and post-secondary school world, with an emphasis on overcoming obstacles through effort. Each year culminates in scholars completing high stakes applications which prepare them for the college application process. High school scholars apply to and attend a variety of summer programs to prepare them for the college experience and the diverse populations they will encounter when moving onto college campuses

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

## Elm City Montessori School District

### **Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools**

The Elm City College Preparatory School district is comprised of two individual school campuses. Each school has a Director of Operations (DSO) that is responsible for non-instructional activities within the school including budgeting and resource acquisition. DSOs from each campus across the Achievement First network meet regularly in a DSO Cohort to norm around processes, procedures, and activities within their schools.

The Elm City Board of Directors reviews and approves the annual budget, as well as the financial reports at each of their meetings. These include school-level detail with key comparable metrics. Financial reporting is centralized, Achievement First's Chief Financial Officer ensures resources are allocated similarly throughout the network.

Elm City regularly reviews data and adjusts the resource allocation process to ensure that it remains responsive to evolving student needs and maintains equity. This review may include input from school administrators, teachers, parents, and community stakeholders. Adjustments may be made based on changes in student demographics, academic performance, or other relevant factors.